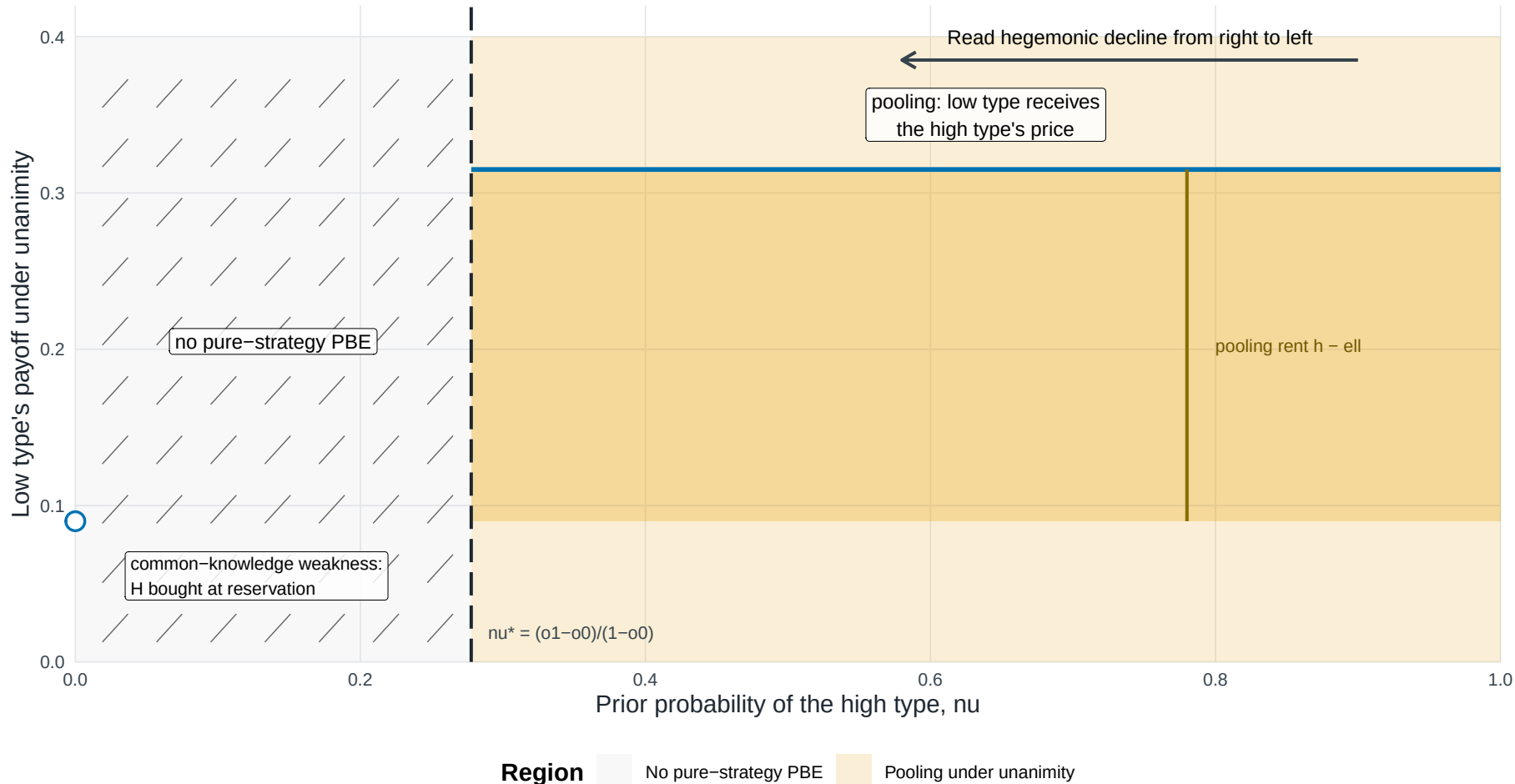


Hegemonic decline across pooling, an empty pure-strategy cell, and the endpoint

$\alpha_0 = 0.100$; $\alpha_1 = 0.350$; $m = 4$ weak states; $\beta = 0.90$



The figure should be read from high to low ν . Above ν^* , pooling pays the low type $h = \beta \times \alpha_1$, creating the rent $h - \ell$ relative to its reservation price $\ell = \beta \times \alpha_0$. The light orange field identifies the pooling region; the darker band isolates the payoff-relevant rent between ℓ and h . For $0 < \nu \leq \nu^*$, the hatched area records the absence of a perfect Bayesian equilibrium in pure ballot strategies; $\nu = 0$ is an isolated complete-information endpoint, not an interval, and the low type is bought at reservation. The figure makes no claim about equilibria involving mixed ballot strategies. Note: Model-generated regions; all boundaries closed-form.